ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 74

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Malagasy Alphabet

Ny abidiko voalohany amin’ny teny malagasy

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 21 Malagasy Letters with English Phonetics

A a B b D d

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Malagasy Alphabet — Ny abidiko voalohany amin'ny teny malagasy
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 74

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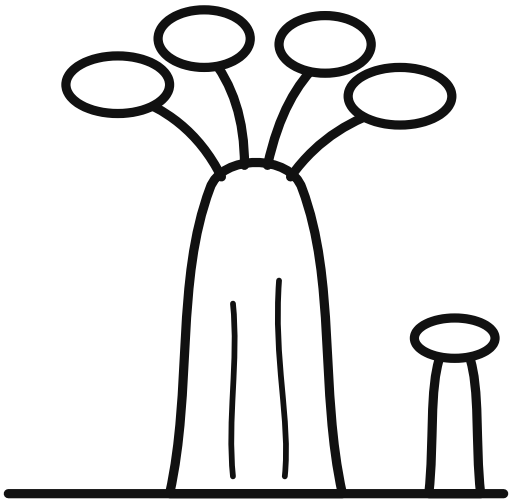
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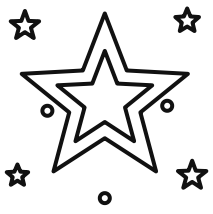
A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



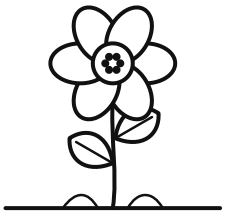
This book belongs to

An'i ... ity boky ity

I started learning Malagasy on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 74 is Malagasy. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** show the stressed syllable: *RAH-noo* means "say RAH a little louder".
- The last vowel of a Malagasy word is often said very softly: *vary* can sound almost like "VAHR".
- **oo** is how Malagasy O sounds; **dz** is how Malagasy J sounds.
- **tr** and **dr** are said together quickly, as in English "tree" and "dream".

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Malagasy name** written in Malagasy (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Malagasy name · syllables* shows the name children use for the letter (B is «ba», D is «da») and its row of syllables — the way Malagasy is taught in school.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Official Malagasy (based on the speech of the central highlands).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Malagasy! teny malagasy

TEH-nee mah-lah-GAHSS — the Malagasy word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **25 million people** speak Malagasy — nearly everyone on the island of Madagascar.[3]

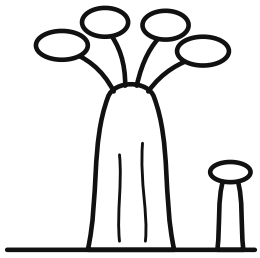
Where?
On **Madagascar**, a very big island in the **Indian Ocean**, east of Africa. Its capital is **Antananarivo**, "the city of a thousand".

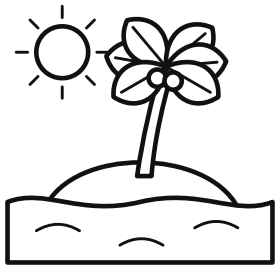
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**, for about 200 years. Long before that, Malagasy was written in **Arabic letters**, a way of writing called *sorabe*, "big writing".

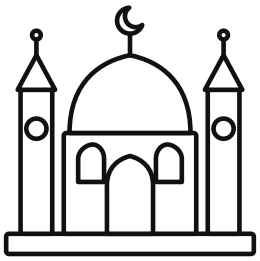
How many letters?
21 letters: A B D E F G H I J K L M N O P R S T V Y Z.

A cousin far away
Malagasy's closest cousins are spoken on the island of **Borneo**, thousands of kilometres away. Sailors crossed the ocean long, long ago!

Did you know?
Some days of the week come from Arabic: *Talata* (Tuesday), *Alarobia* (Wednesday), *Alakamisy* (Thursday) and *Zoma* (Friday, from *al-jumuʿa*). And *Salama!* (hello) comes from *salām*, peace.





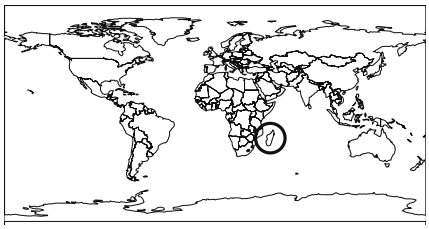


The Malagasy Alphabet ny abidy

21 letters — ny abidy malagasy

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bah*	**Dd** *dah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fah*	**Gg** *gah*	**Hh** *hah*
Ii *ee*	**Jj** *dzee*	**Kk** *kah*	**Ll** *lah*	**Mm** *mah*	**Nn** *nah*	**Oo** *oo*
Pp *pah*	**Rr** *rah*	**Ss** *sah*	**Tt** *tah*	**Vv** *vah*	**Yy** *ee*	**Zz** *zah*

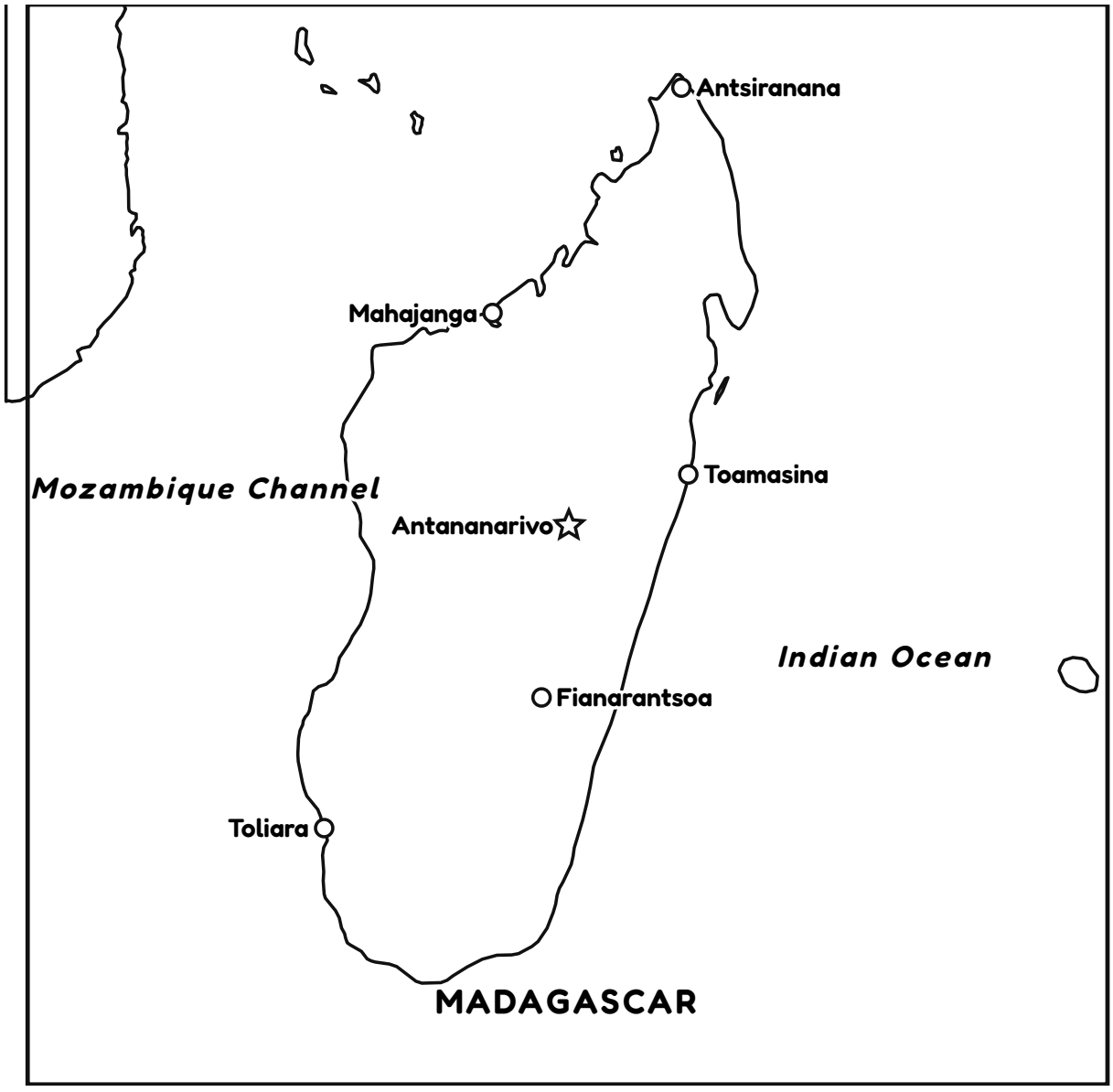
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Madagascar on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Malagasy spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Malagasy is spoken all over the island, in Antananarivo, Toamasina, Mahajanga, Fianarantsoa, Toliara and Antsiranana.

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THE LETTERS

The Letters ny abidy malagasy

nee ah-BEE-dee mah-lah-GAHSS — “the Malagasy A-B-C”

Malagasy is written with **21 letters**. It has no C, Q, U, W or X.

Four vowel sounds
A E I O say *ah*, *eh*, *ee*, *oo*. Yes — Malagasy **O** says *oo*, and **Y** says *ee*, just like I. Children learn to read by singing the syllables: *ba be bi bo, da de di do…*

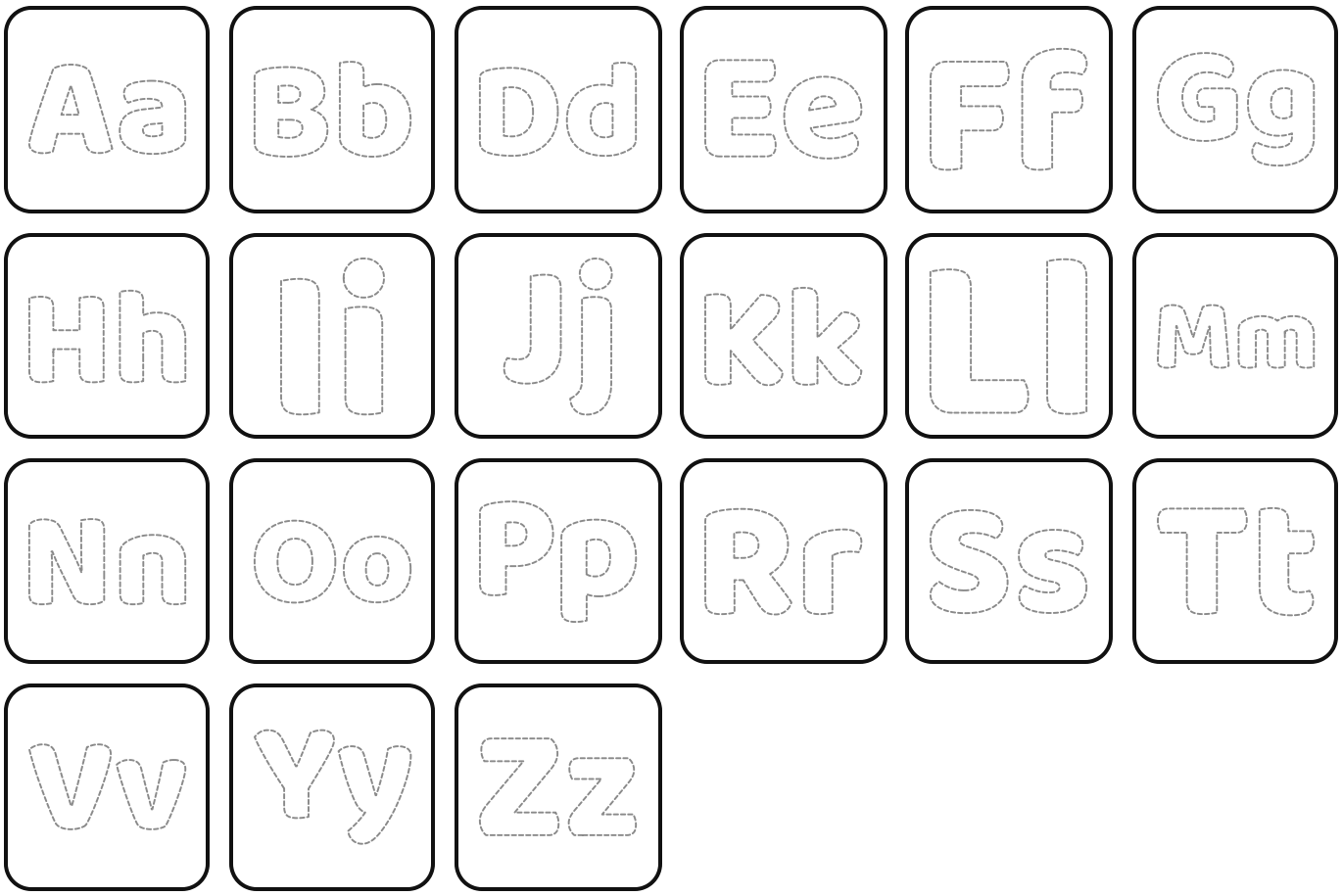
Letter friends
Some letters like to stand together: **tr** (as in “tree”), **dr** (as in “dream”), **ts** (as in “cats”), and **mb, nd, ng, nj, nt**, where the M or N hums into the next letter.

Big and small
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Aa**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters ny abidy malagasy

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · ANARANA

a

ah

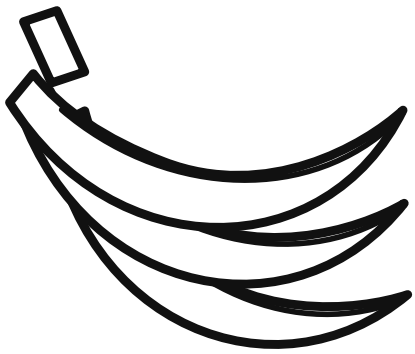
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · ma



AA IS FOR

akondro

ah-KOON-droo

banana

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Aa Aa Aa Aa

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Bb

NAME · ANARANA

ba

bah

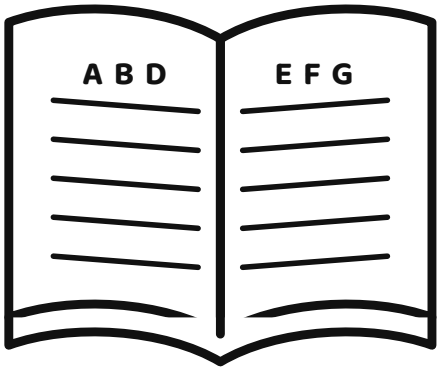
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

B b — «ba»

ba · be · bi · bo



BB IS FOR

boky

BOO-kee

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Bb Bb Bb Bb

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Dd

NAME · ANARANA

da

dah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “door”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

D d — «da»

da · de · di · do

dr sounds like the ‘dr’ in “dream”: *adrisa*



DD IS FOR

dite

DEE-teh

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Dd Dd Dd Dd

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Ee

NAME · ANARANA

e

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “bed”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · me



EE IS FOR

entana

EN-tah-nah

luggage, things you carry

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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Ff

NAME · ANARANA

fa

fah

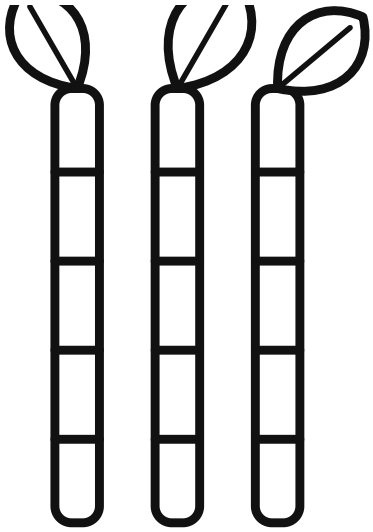
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

F f — «fa»

fa · fe · fi · fo



FF IS FOR

fary

FAH-ree

sugarcane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Ff Ff Ff Ff

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Gg

NAME · ANARANA

ga

gah

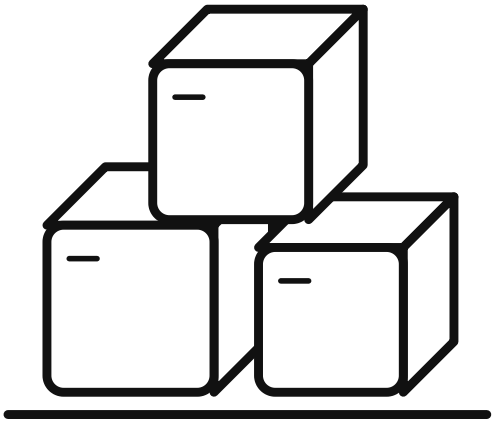
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go” (always hard)

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

G g — «ga»

ga · ge · gi · go



GG IS FOR

gilasy

gee-LAH-see

ice, ice cream

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Gg Gg Gg Gg

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Hh

NAME · ANARANA

ha

hah

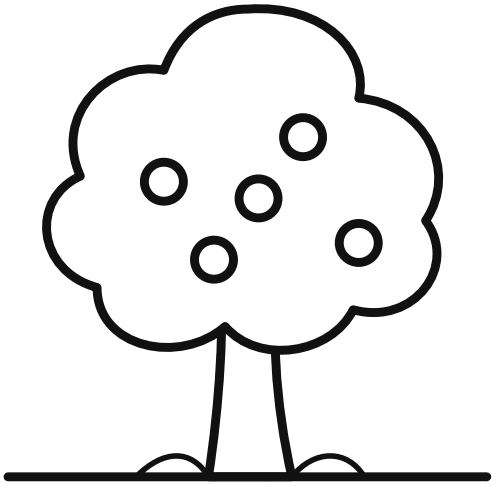
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a very soft ‘h’ — often you hardly hear it

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

H h — «ha»

ha · he · hi · ho



HH IS FOR

hazo

HAH-zoo

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Hh Hh Hh Hh

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Ii

NAME · ANARANA

i

ee

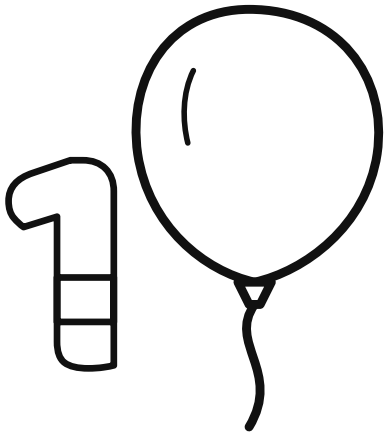
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

| i — «i»

bi · di · ki · mi



II IS FOR

isa

EE-sah

one (when you count)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

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Jj

NAME · ANARANA

ji

dzee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

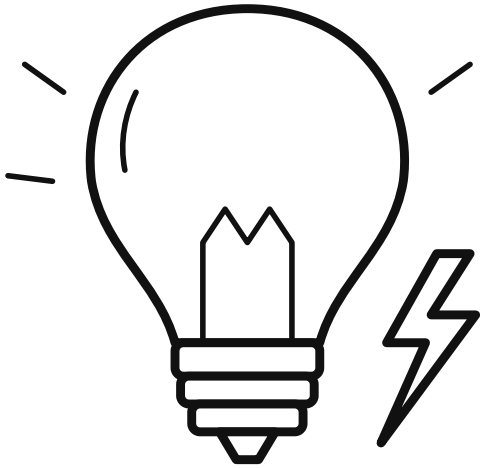
‘dz’ — a ‘d’ and a ‘z’ said together

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

J j — «ji»

ja · je · ji · jo

Careful: Malagasy J does not sound like English J. *jiro* sounds like “DZEE-roo”.



JJ IS FOR

jiro

DZEE-roo

lamp, light

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · ANARANA

ka

kah

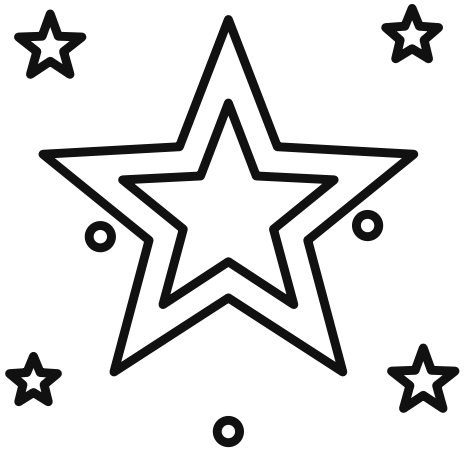
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

K k — «ka»

ka · ke · ki · ko



KK IS FOR

kintana

KEEN-tah-nah

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Ll

NAME · ANARANA

la

lah

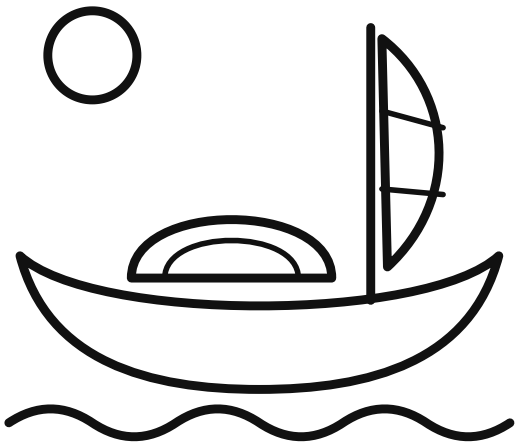
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘l’ as in “lamp”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

L l — «la»

la · le · li · lo



LL IS FOR

lakana

LAH-kah-nah

canoe

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Ll Ll Ll Ll

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Mm

NAME · ANARANA

ma

mah

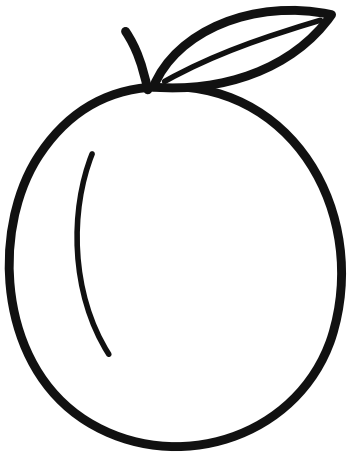
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

M m — «ma»

ma · me · mi · mo



MM IS FOR

manga

MAHN-gah

mango

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · ANARANA

na

nah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

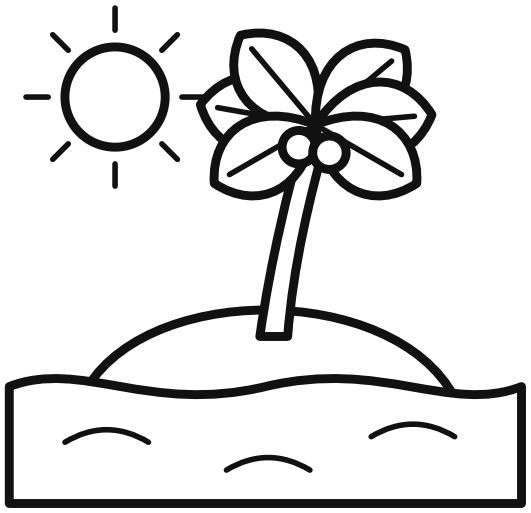
‘n’ as in “net”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

N n — «na»

na · ne · ni · no

N and M often hold hands with the next letter: ma**ng**a, sa**mb**o, ki**nt**ana



NN IS FOR

nosy

NOO-see

island

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Oo

NAME · ANARANA

O

oo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon” — Malagasy O says “oo”!

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · mo

O always says “oo”: *rano* (water) is “RAH-noo”.



OO IS FOR

orana

OO-rah-nah

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Oo Oo Oo Oo

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Pp

NAME · ANARANA

pa

pah

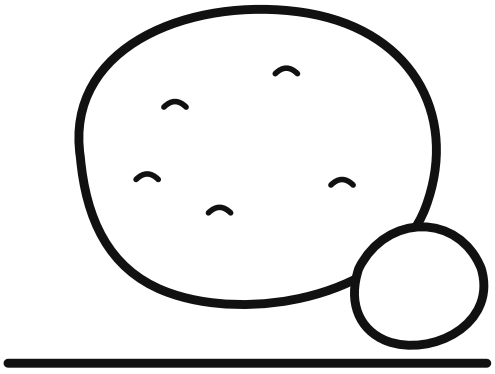
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

P p — «pa»

pa · pe · pi · po



PP IS FOR

pataty

pah-TAH-tee

sweet potato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Rr

NAME · ANARANA

ra

rah

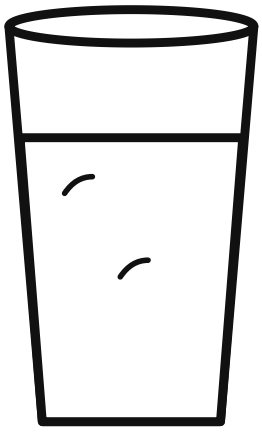
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a rolled or tapped ‘r’

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

R r — «ra»

ra · re · ri · ro



RR IS FOR

rano

RAH-noo

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Rr Rr Rr Rr

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Ss Ss

NAME · ANARANA

sa

sah

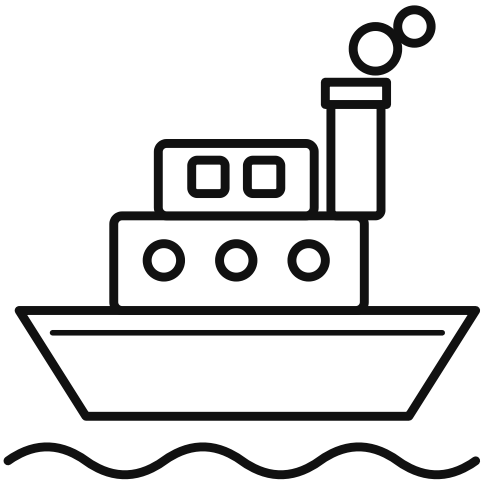
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

S s — «sa»

sa · se · si · so



SS IS FOR

sambo

SAHM-boo

ship

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Tt

NAME · ANARANA

ta

tah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

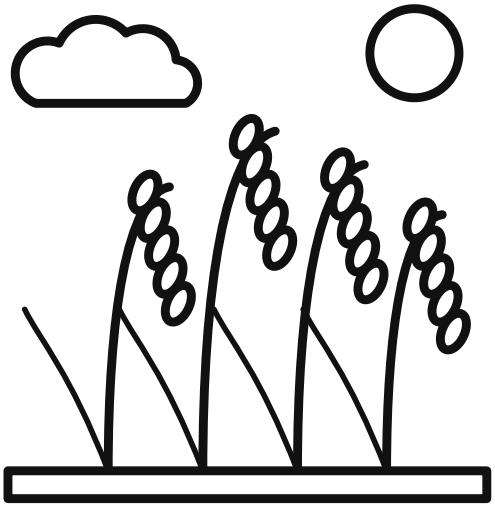
‘t’ as in “tap”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

T t — «ta»

ta · te · ti · to

tr sounds like the ‘tr’ in “tree” · ts sounds like the ‘ts’ in “cats”



TT IS FOR

tanimbary

tah-neem-BAH-ree

rice field

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Vv

NAME · ANARANA

va

vah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘v’ as in “van”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

V v — «va»

va · ve · vi · vo



VV IS FOR

vary

VAH-ree

rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Vv Vv Vv Vv

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Yy

NAME · ANARANA

y

ee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ee' as in "see" — the same sound as I

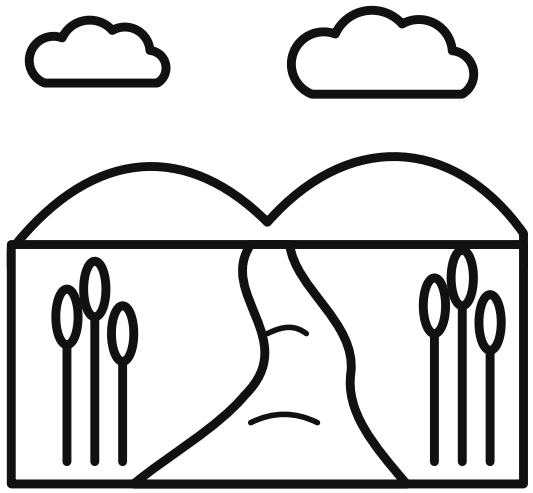
MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

Y y — «y»

by · dy · ky · my

i inside a word · y at the end of a word: bok**y**, var**y**, nos**y**

Y almost never starts a word. Find it at the end of *ony* — and of *boky*, *fary* and *vary*!



YY IS FOR

ony

OO-nee

river

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

Yy Yy Yy Yy

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Zz

NAME · ANARANA

za

zah

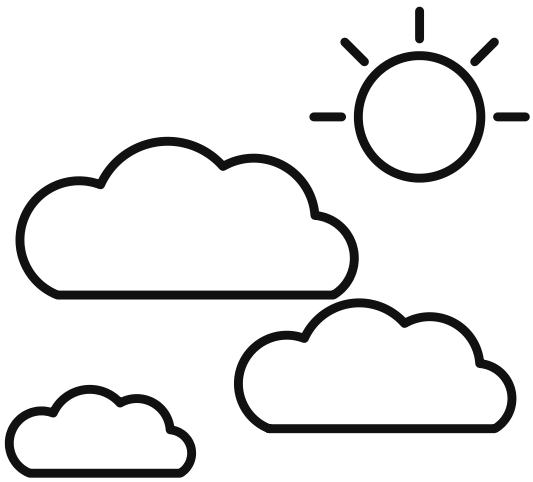
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

MALAGASY NAME · SYLLABLES

Z z — «za»

za · ze · zi · zo



ZZ IS FOR

zavona

ZAH-voo-nah

mist, fog

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · SORATY

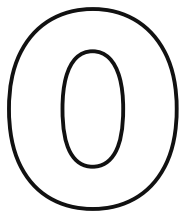
Zz Zz Zz Zz

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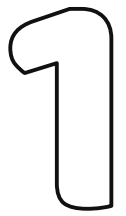
BONUS

Malagasy numbers ny isa *(nee EE-sah)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Malagasy: *OW-tchah*, *ee-RAI*, *ROO-ah*, *TEH-loo*...



0
aotra
OW-tchah
zero



1
iray
ee-RAI
one



2
roa
ROO-ah
two



3
telo
TEH-loo
three



4
efatra
EH-fah-tchah
four



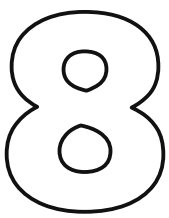
5
dimy
DEE-mee
five



6
enina
EH-nee-nah
six



7
fito
FEE-too
seven



8
valo
VAH-loo
eight



9
sivy
SEE-vee
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Malagasy words Teny voalohany

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalamu alaikum

as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAI-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Wa alaikum assalam

wah ah-LAI-koom as-sah-LAHM
And peace be upon you (the reply)

Salama! · Manao ahoana!

sah-LAHM · mah-NOW ah-OHN
Hello! · How are you?

Ny anarako dia …

nee ah-NAH-rah-koo dee …
My name is …

Misaotra

mee-SOW-tchah
Thank you

Jazakallahu khairan

jah-zah-KAHL-lah-hoo KHAI-rahn
May Allah reward you with good

neny · dada

NEH-nee · DAH-dah
Mother · Father

rahalahy · anabavy

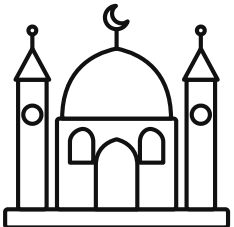
rah-hah-LAH-hee · ah-nah-BAH-vee
Brother · Sister (when a boy speaks)

eny · tsia

EH-nee · TSEE
Yes · No

Mianatra teny malagasy aho!

mee-AH-nah-tchah TEH-nee mah-lah-GAHSS ah-OO
I am learning Malagasy!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

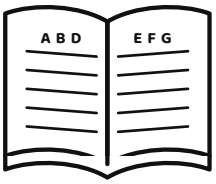
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

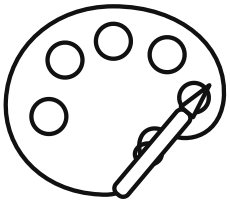
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **21 Malagasy letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Malagasy, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! Tsara be!

MAH-shah-lah! TSAH-rah BEH! — Mashallah! Very good!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 21 letters of the Malagasy alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

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